

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent
Kind Code
Date of Patent
Inventor(s)

12399067
B2
August 26, 2025
Chen; Tz-Shian et al.

Apparatus, system, and method for measuring the temperature of a substrate

Abstract

A temperature measuring apparatus for measuring a temperature of a substrate is described. A light emitting source that emits light signals such as laser pulses are applied to the substrate. A detector on the other side of the light emitting source receives the reflected laser pulses. The detector further receives emission signals associated with temperature or energy density that is radiated from the surface of the substrate. The temperature measuring apparatus determines the temperature of the substrate during a thermal process using the received laser pulses and the emission signals. To improve the signal to noise ratio of the reflected laser pulses, a polarizer may be used to polarize the laser pulses to have a S polarization. The angle in which the polarized laser pulses are applied towards the substrate may also be controlled to enhance the signal to noise ratio at the detector's end.

Inventors: Chen; Tz-Shian (Hsinchu, TW), Wang; Yi-Chao (Hsinchu, TW), Chen; Wen-Yen (Hsinchu, TW), Wang; Li-Ting (Hsinchu, TW), Chang; Huicheng (Hsinchu, TW), Yeo; Yee-Chia (Hsinchu, TW)

Applicant: Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co., Ltd. (Hsinchu, TW)

Family ID: 1000008778598

Assignee: Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co., Ltd. (Hsinchu, TW)

Appl. No.: 17/461688

Filed: August 30, 2021

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230060543 A1	Mar. 02, 2023

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G01K11/125 (20210101); H01L21/66 (20060101); H01L21/67 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G01K11/125 (20130101); H01L21/67248 (20130101); H01L22/12 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
2006/0215165	12/2005	Melman	356/445	G01N 21/553
2007/0119815	12/2006	Zhang	216/65	H01L 29/66757
2008/0081298	12/2007	Tanaka	430/327	G03F 7/70383

Primary Examiner: Lin; Erica S

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Seed Intellectual Property Law Group LLP

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Various methods and approaches may be used in monitoring the anneal process during a semiconductor manufacturing process. One approach of monitoring the anneal process includes using a time resolved reflectivity TRR method. However, such method is not effective in detecting the slight variations that occur during this process. Such shortcomings of the time resolved reflectivity method may lead to a degraded process control of the overall semiconductor manufacturing process.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Aspects of the present disclosure are best understood from the following detailed description when read with the accompanying figures. It is noted that, in accordance with the standard practice in the industry, various features are not drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

(2) FIG. 1A illustrates a schematic diagram of a temperature evaluating system for a substrate according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 1B illustrates a schematic diagram of a temperature evaluating system for a substrate according to further embodiments of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 2A illustrates a graph showing the fluctuation of the time resolved reflectivity signals at a melt region and a sub-melt region.

- (5) FIG. 2B illustrates a graph showing time resolved reflectivity for different phase transition in terms of energy density with melting signal.
- (6) FIG. 3A illustrates a reflection and penetration of light signals at a surface of a substrate having thereon metallic structures.
- (7) FIG. 3B illustrates a reflectance rate of TE waves, TM waves based on an angle of incidence θ as provided from RefractiveIndex.info.
- (8) FIG. 4 illustrates a graph showing a signal to noise ratio of a time resolved reflectivity signal for TE waves and TM waves.
- (9) FIG. 5 illustrates a schematic diagram showing a first movable device and a second movable device according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 6A is a layout of an example chip having thereon various components.
- (11) FIG. 6B is a layout of another example chip having thereon various components.
- (12) FIG. 7 is a graph illustrating the range of energy density capable of being detected using a combination of emission signals and reflectivity signals according to temperature measuring apparatus of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIGS. 8A and 8B are graphs showing that a light emitting source may be calibrated to improve reflectivity according to the present disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 9 is a method of evaluating a temperature of a substrate according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (15) The following disclosure provides many different embodiments, or examples, for implementing different features of the provided subject matter. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over or on a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact, and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. In addition, the present disclosure may repeat reference numerals and/or letters in the various examples. This repetition is for the purpose of simplicity and clarity and does not in itself dictate a relationship between the various embodiments and/or configurations discussed.
- (16) Further, spatially relative terms, such as “beneath,” “below,” “lower,” “above,” “upper” and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. The spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. The apparatus may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein may likewise be interpreted accordingly. Terms such as “attached,” “affixed,” “connected” and “interconnected,” refer to a relationship wherein structures are secured or attached to one another either directly or indirectly through intervening structures, as well as both movable or rigid attachments or relationships, unless expressly described otherwise.
- (17) Unless otherwise defined, all terms (including technical and scientific terms) used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which this disclosure belongs. It will be further understood that terms, such as those defined in commonly used dictionaries, should be interpreted as having a meaning that is consistent with their meaning in the context of the relevant art and the present disclosure, and will not be interpreted in an idealized or overly formal sense unless expressly so defined herein.
- (18) Reference will now be made in detail to the present embodiments of the disclosure, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Wherever possible, the same reference numbers are used in the drawings and the description to refer to the same or like parts.

(19) The inventors of the present disclosure recognized the problems of process control worsening due to the time resolved reflectivity method for anneal monitoring in the related art. Accordingly, the inventors came up with a method of metrology that utilizes both time resolved reflectivity and time resolved emission for advanced anneal monitoring. The inventors recognized that using the combination of reflectivity signals and emission signals improves the accuracy and preciseness of determining the processing temperature.

(20) In one or more embodiments, the present disclosure provides a novel in-situ monitor processing for sub-melt annealing and melt annealing and overcomes the short comings of the time resolved reflectivity method in the related art.

(21) FIG. 1A illustrates a schematic diagram of a temperature evaluating system **100** for a substrate according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The temperature evaluating system **100** includes a light emitting source **110**, a detector **120**, a polarizer **130** (or a polarized source), and a heating source **140**. The light emitting source **110** generates light signals **115** such as a laser, however, the type of light signals may vary depending on the light emitting source **110**. In some embodiments, the light emitting source **110** includes a probe laser. In some embodiments, the light emitting source **110** includes a diode laser. The generated light signals **115** of the light emitting source **110** include transverse magnetic (TM) waves and transverse electric (TE) waves.

(22) In operation, the light emitting source **110** emits the light signals **115** towards a surface of a substrate **150**. The examples of the substrate **150** includes a silicon Si substrate, a SiGe substrate, and a SiP substrate, or the like. The subject of the temperature evaluating system or apparatus also includes metal lines having periodic patterns. For example, the temperature evaluating system or apparatus according to the present disclosure not only detects the temperature of surfaces of the aforementioned Si substrates, SiGe substrates, SiP substrates, but also the periodic metal line patterns formed on these Si substrates, SiGe substrates, SiP substrates. When the light signals **115** reach the surface of the substrate **150**, the light signals **115** are reflected off of the surface and the reflected portion of the light signals **115** is received at the detector **120**.

(23) In one or more embodiments, the polarizer **130** is positioned adjacent to the light emitting source **110**. That is, the polarizer **130** is arranged in a way so the light from the light emitting source **110** passes through the polarizer **130** before it reaches the surface of the substrate **150**. In some embodiments, the polarizer **130** may be implemented within the light emitting source **110** and form a unitary component. The polarizer **130** is configured to polarize the light signals **115** emitted from the light emitting source **110**. In some embodiments, the polarizer **130** may be further configured to polarize the light signals **115** so that the polarized light signals **125** include the transverse electric waves. Here, the polarizer **130** may reduce or eliminate the transverse magnetic waves from the light signals **115** after polarization. The polarizer **130** improves the signal to noise ratio of the signals received at the detector's end. The features of the polarizer **130** will be further detailed below.

(24) The polarized light signals **125** including the transverse electric waves are propagated towards the substrate **150** at a first angle θ (i.e., incident angle) and a second angle (i.e., angle between a polarization direction and a central axis of the substrate). The detector **120** is configured to receive the reflected polarized light signals **127** (e.g., time resolved reflectivity signals) from the surface of the substrate **150**. Further, the detector **120** is configured to receive emission signals **160** associated with at least one of a temperature or energy density of a surface of the substrate **150**. For example, when the heating source **140** (e.g., laser) is applied to the substrate **150** during, for example, an anneal process (uses the laser to anneal the substrate), the substrate **150** after being heated, radiates emission signals **160** associated with the heat.

(25) For example, when the surface of the substrate **150** increases in temperature, emission signals **160** emitted from the substrate **150** increase (e.g., at a high temperature, high emission signals are emitted). Also, when the substrate **150** increases in temperature, the energy density of the substrate **150** increases, which in turn increases the radiation of emission signals **160**. The detector **120** is

configured to receive the emission signals **160** produced from the surface of the substrate **150**. In some embodiments, the emission signals **160** may be detected based on intensity, density, wavelength, frequency, or some other suitable parameters. For example, when the substrate shows high temperature, the emission signals **160** may have high energy density. However, other parameters may be used to measure the intensity of the emission signals. In some embodiments, the emission signals **160** may include, but are not limited to, infrared signals.

(26) As described, adding the polarizer **130** to the light emitting source **110** improves the reflectivity signal as the polarizer **130**, for example, passes mostly or only TE signals (or waves). Further, the angle in which the light signals **115** are applied to the substrate may be adjusted. Adjusting the first angle θ and the second angle Ω may produce light signals **115** having different polarization. For example, by controlling the first angle θ and the second angle Ω , it is possible to obtain a 100% S-polarization or a 90% S-polarization and 10% P-polarization. By adjusting the angles, the detector **120** may receive better signal to noise ratio.

(27) In some embodiments, the wavelength applied by the heating source **140** ranges between about 300 nm to 320 nm. The wavelength applied by the light emitting source **110** ranges between about 600 nm to 650 nm. The range of wavelengths used by the detector **120** to receive emission signals **160** and reflectivity signals **127** is between about 1500 nm to 1600 nm. The range of the wavelengths of the emission signals **160** are broader than that of the reflectivity signals **127** in order to detect more emission signals **160** at the detector **120**. For example, bandwidth for the emission signals **160** are broader than that of the wavelength used in the light emitting source **110**. As explained, with broader range of wavelengths, the detector **120** is capable of collecting more signals.

(28) In some embodiments, the detector **120** may be implemented using any one of InGaAs, InSb, InAs, PbS, or the like. For example, InGaAs may be used to detect signals having wavelengths about 1500 nm, and InSb may be used to detect signals having wavelengths about 900 nm, and so forth. Various different materials may be used to detect emission signals with various wavelengths. These examples are not exhaustive and a person of ordinary skill in the art would understand that other suitable materials may be utilized for detecting emission signals **160** and the reflected polarized light signals **127** (e.g., time resolved reflectivity signals). The detector **120** can monitor the change of the reflectivity at various points of the substrate **150** to monitor the temperature of the surface of the substrate **150** in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(29) In some embodiments, the heating source **140** may include a laser, a flash lamp, a lamp (with a bulb), or the like. In the anneal monitoring process of some embodiments of the present disclosure, any one of a laser, a flash lamp, a lamp with a bulb may be used as the anneal energy source.

(30) The temperature evaluating system **100** may evaluate a temperature of the surface of the substrate **150** using the combination of the reflected polarized light signals **127** and the emission signals **160** from the substrate **150**. The emission signals **160** are independent from the reflected polarized light signals **127** (or the reflectivity signals **R**). In addition, the emission signals **160** are synchronized with the reflectivity signals **127**. The benefit of synchronizing the emission signals **160** and the reflectivity signals **127** is that it produces a more precise temperature calculation. Moreover, synchronizing the two signals results in simplifying the temperature calculation process.

(31) In one or more embodiments, the temperature evaluating system **100** evaluates the temperature of the surface of the substrate **150** by calculating the temperature of the surface of the substrate based on the following equation:

$$(32) T = \frac{A}{\ln(1 + B \cdot \frac{E}{TRE})}$$

(33) Here, T is the temperature of the substrate **150**, A and B are constant parameters, E is emissivity which equals $1 - R$ %. R is an intensity of the reflected polarized light signals **127**, and TRE is an intensity of the emission signals. Constant parameter A is as follows:

$$(34) A = \frac{h \cdot c}{K}$$

(35) Constant parameter B is as follows:

$$(36) B() = \frac{2h \cdot c^2 \cdot G \cdot \Delta\lambda \cdot R()}{5}$$

(37) λ : center wavelength=1550E-9 m; $\Delta\lambda$: spectrum range; c: velocity of light (m.Math.s.sup.-1); h: Planck's constant (6.63E-34 m.sup.2.Math.kg.Math.s.sup.-1); K: Boltzmann constant (1.38E-23J.Math.K.sup.-1); R(λ): spectral sensitivity of the detector/sensor; τ : total optical transmission of the system; G is the etendue of the optical system (m.sup.2.Math.sr.sup.-1).

(38) In some embodiments, the intensity of the reflected polarized light signals **127** and the intensity of the emission signals may be measured in voltages. However, other metrics may be used to measure the intensity of the reflected polarized light signals **127** and the intensity of the emission signals. For example, if the light emitting source **110** outputs 100 W and the detector **120** detects about 18 W. It is possible to determine that the reflectivity of the substrate is about 18%. As described, other metrics may be used other than watt.

(39) In some embodiments, the polarized light signals **125** are propagated toward the substrate **150** at the first angle θ . The first angle θ in which the light signals **125** from the light emitting source **110** are incident on a surface of a substrate **150** or a substrate **150** can be controlled. In some embodiments, an oblique incidence angle θ is beneficial in the operation of, for example, the in situ anneal monitoring system. For example, it may be beneficial to have the first angle θ (e.g., an incidence angle) ranging from 10° to 80°. The polarized light signals **125** may be propagated toward the substrate **150** at the second angle Ω that is between about 0° to 85°. In one or more embodiments, a polarized laser incident angle is meaningful for semiconductor structures such as FINFET (fin field-effect transistor) or other periodic structures because the electric field has component along the metal wire direction or for a periodic structure, along the long axis (or the length direction) of the structure. For example, the incident electric has component along the metal grid. This means higher reflection signal for the detector **120** and better S/N ratio as shown in FIG. 4.

(40) The temperature evaluating system or apparatus may be used not only in the laser anneal processes (at the sub melt region and the melt region) but also may be implemented in other semiconductor processes including thermal processes (e.g., thermal annealing). Further, the method of calculating the surface of the temperature T according to the above equation is independent from the anneal process itself. That is, the measurement process and the anneal process can be independent which is also another benefit of some embodiments of the present disclosure.

(41) FIG. 1B illustrates a schematic diagram of a temperature evaluating system for a substrate according to further embodiments of the present disclosure.

(42) For example, FIG. 1B illustrates the light signal propagation of the light **180** emitted from the light emitting source **110**. The light **180** is reflected from the surface of the substrate **150** and received at a receiver **170** and then to a detector **120b** configured to receive light **180** from the light emitting source **110**. In some embodiments, the receiver **170** receives the light **180** and reflects to the appropriate detector **120b** for analyzing the light **180** (which includes the time resolved reflectivity (TRR) signals). An emission signals **190** reflected from the surface of the substrate **150** is also received at the receiver **170** and then to a detector **120a** configured to receive emission signals **190** from the surface of the substrate **150**. The emission signals **190** include the time resolved emission (TRE) signals.

(43) In some embodiments, the temperature evaluating system is operatively coupled to a processor **195** (or controller **195**). The processor **195** may include any electrical circuitry, features, components, an assembly of electronic components or the like configured to perform the various operations of the temperature evaluating system as described herein. In some embodiments, the processor **195** may be included in or otherwise implemented by processing circuitry such as a microprocessor, microcontroller, integrated circuit, chip, microchip or the like.

(44) FIG. 2A illustrates a graph showing the fluctuation of the time resolved reflectivity signals at a

melt region and a sub-melt region. As shown, the x-axis indicates the time in nanoseconds (ns) and the y-axis indicates voltages indicative of energy densities (e.g., melting voltages). The time resolved reflectivity (TRR) signals are shown to increase as the heating source **140** applied against the substrate **150** increases the temperature of the substrate **150**. The melt region is indicated by a circle on the bottom of the graph (close to the x-axis) and the sub-melt region is indicated by a circle on the top of the graph. In the melt region, however, the time resolved reflectivity signals drastically drop at melting voltages. This is at least partially due to the fact that a structure (e.g., a component, a metal wiring, or the like) on the substrate **150** or the substrate **150** itself has reached the melting point and melted. For example, when the light signals (e.g., laser or laser pulse) hit the substrate, the reflectivity changes. While the sub melt region is still at a solid phase, once it reaches the melt region, it will reach a liquid phase (will have more like a mirror like effect with respect to reflectivity) and the reflectivity will change. That is, when there is a phase transition, for example from a solid phase to a liquid phase, the time resolved reflectivity signals change. When the time resolved reflectivity signals are used to detect whether there was a phase transition during the anneal process, only utilizing the time resolved reflectivity signals creates problems as shown in FIG. 2A.

(45) Accordingly, the detection of the precise time when the structures on the substrate **150** melted was not possible to obtain using only the time resolved reflectivity signals. Namely, the detection of when the structures on the substrate **150** melted could be identified only after the structure on the substrate **150** has already started to melt or already melted and not prior to the meltdown. FIG. 2B also illustrates a similar problem that stems from only utilizing the time resolved reflectivity signals to evaluate the temperature of the surface of the substrate **150**.

(46) FIG. 2B illustrates a graph showing time resolved reflectivity for different phase transitions in terms of energy density with melting signal. As shown, the x-axis indicates the time in nanoseconds (ns) and the y-axis on the left indicates voltages of the laser pulse applied from the heating source **140** and the y-axis on the right indicates voltages (e.g., melting voltages) of the time resolved reflectivity signals. The time resolved reflectivity (TRR) signals are shown to increase shortly after the laser pulse is applied against the substrate **150**. For example, the peak of the time resolved reflectivity signals (at approximately around 180 ns) comes shortly after the peak of the laser pulse voltages (at approximately around 120 ns). However, once the temperature reaches the melting point, the voltages of the time resolved reflectivity signals plummets. Similarly, as explained in connection with FIG. 2A, this is at least partially due to the fact that a structure on the substrate **150** or the substrate **150** itself has reached the melting point and melted and a phase transition has occurred (for example, from a solid phase to a liquid phase). FIG. 2B, similar to FIG. 2A, illustrates a problem of only utilizing the time resolved reflectivity signals to evaluate the temperature of the surface of the substrate **150**.

(47) As described above, reflectivity is sensitive to phase change (e.g., changes from solid phase to liquid phase, or the like). That is, the sudden change in reflectivity implies that the substrate **150** is starting to melt and at this point, the temperature may be very close to the melting point. In accordance with some embodiments described herein, by changing the polarization of the light emitting source **110** through the polarizer **130**, a more sensitive TRR profile (or reflectivity signal profile) is obtained. This will be further detailed below. For example, the S-polarization has a significantly higher reflectivity output (or signal to noise ratio) compared to the P-polarization. While using the P-polarization still enables the temperature evaluating apparatus to detect the signal, the detected signal here is either weak or unclear. Accordingly, in one or more embodiments, the S-polarization is used to detect the reflectivity profile. This will be further described in connection with FIGS. 3A, and 3B.

(48) FIG. 3A illustrates a reflection and penetration of light signals **115** at a surface of a substrate **150** having thereon metallic structures **310**. The coordinates may be expressed in Cartesian coordinates as well. FIG. 3B illustrates a reflectance rate of TE waves, TM waves based on an

angle of incidence θ as provided from RefractiveIndex.info. FIG. 4 illustrates a graph showing a signal to noise ratio of a time resolved reflectivity signal for TE waves and TM waves. In one or more embodiments, the substrate 150 may have various metallic structure 310 or patterned structures mounted on the substrate 150. The metallic structure 310 includes components, wirings, or the like. For example, the metallic structure 310 includes metal wire grids.

(49) Referring to FIG. 3A, the light signals 115 from the light emitting source 110 are propagated towards the surface of the substrate 150. When the light signals 115 including the TE waves and the TM waves contact the metallic structures 310 on the substrate 150, a portion of the light signals (e.g., TM waves 320) penetrates through (or transmits through) the metallic structures 310 and the substrate 150. The TE waves 330 are reflected from the metallic structure 310.

(50) FIG. 3B illustrates a reflectance rate of TE waves, TM waves, and non-polarized waves. As shown, as the angle of incidence θ varies from 0 degrees to 90 degrees, the reflectance rate of TM waves are maintained below 0.4 unless the light signals are applied at an incident angle of 90 degrees. However, for TE waves, the reflectance rate is generally between 0.38 and 1 from 0 degrees to 90 degrees incident angle. Further, it shows that using a polarizer 130 may produce light signals with higher reflectivity. Accordingly, the temperature evaluating apparatus may control the reflectivity based at least upon the polarization of the light signals, angle θ , angle ϕ , and wavelength. Further factors may be considered beside the aforementioned components to improve the signal to noise ratio at the detector's end.

(51) As shown in FIG. 4 which indicates time (in nanoseconds) in the x-axis and outputted reflectivity in voltages in the y-axis, the signal to noise ratio is better for the TE waves 330 (see S-polarization). This is partially because most of the TM waves 320 (see P-polarization) penetrate through the substrate 150 and are not reflected from the surface of the metallic structure 310 or the substrate 150 to be received at the detector 120. TM waves 320 which have P-polarization have restricted movement of electrons perpendicular to the metallic structures 310 (e.g., metal wires). This causes the TM waves 320 to have a low reflection (e.g., the TM waves 320 transmit through the substrate 150) which in turn causes low sensitivity for detection. On the other hand, the TE waves 330 are better reflected from the surface of the metallic structure 310 or the substrate 150 than the TM waves 320, and are received at a relatively higher ratio at the detector 120 than the TM waves 320.

(52) Accordingly, in one or more embodiments, it is beneficial to utilize the polarizer 130 (as shown in FIG. 1A) such that the light signals 115 emitted from the light emitting source 110 are polarized to produce TE waves 330 as TE waves 330 show better signal to noise ratio compared to TM waves 320 at the detector's end. That is, the polarizer 130 enhances the reflectivity signal which in turn returns better signal to noise ratio.

(53) In further embodiments, the reflectivity signals 127 may be received in real-time during, for example, an anneal period (if the current process is a laser anneal process). For example, the reflectivity signals 127 can be collected in multiple data points where one data point has a 20 ns interval. As shown in FIG. 4, the anneal dwell time appears to be approximately 100 ns. That is, the reflectivity signals 127 for the S-polarization changes roughly from 250 ns to 350 ns. Since the change in the reflectivity signals 127 lasts for about 100 ns (i.e., anneal dwell time), in one embodiment, the reflectivity signals 127 may be detected using the detector 120 every 20 ns. However, other periodic or non-periodic detection with various interval times may be utilized.

(54) FIG. 5 illustrates a schematic diagram showing a first movable device and a second movable device according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The first moveable device 510 is connected to the light emitting source 110 and the detector 120. In operation, the first moveable device 510 moves the light emitting source 110 and the detector 120 with respect to the substrate 150. In one or more embodiments, the first moveable device 510 has at least two degrees of freedom of movements (e.g., two degrees, three degrees, and so forth). The second movable device 520 is opposite the first moveable device 510 and the substrate 150 is mounted on the

second movable device **520**. The second movable device **520** moves concurrently with the substrate **150** on top, and moves with respect to the light emitting source **110** and the detector **120**. In one or more embodiments, the second moveable device **520** has at least two degrees of freedom of movements (e.g., two degrees, three degrees, and so forth). In one or more embodiments, the spot where the light emitting source **110** emits light signals **115** may be changed to mechanically offset the location where the laser is applied using the heating source **140** during, for example, an anneal process. To this end, the first moveable device **510** (e.g., a movable frame, a movable metrology frame, or a stage for metrology frame including the light emitting source **110** and the detector **120**) is capable of moving the position and location of the light emitting source **110** and may have a resolution that is below in the order of mm (micrometers). Similarly, a stage of the substrate resolution is beneficial to be below the order of micrometers. The first moveable device **510** having thereon the light emitting source **110** and the detector **120** and the second moveable device **520** having thereon the substrate **150** may be used as an in situ method for monitoring temperature during the laser anneal process. In one or more embodiments, it is beneficial for the second moveable device **520** (e.g., the stage of the substrate) to be more precise than the first moveable device **510** (e.g., the monitor stage). In some embodiments, the light emitting source **110** and the detector **120** may be mounted on the same plane of the frame (e.g., stage for metrology frame).

(55) FIG. **6A** is a layout of an example chip **600** having thereon various components. As shown, central processing units (CPUs) **610**, graphics processing units (GPUs) **620**, and static random-access memories (SRAMs) **630** are arranged at various locations within the chip **600**. A monitoring spot can be moved to monitor the critical area where the critical components (e.g., CPU, GPU, SRAM, or the like) are located. In some embodiments, the monitor spot is fixed. However, a chip may have the CPUs, GPUs, SRAMs, or other critical components at various locations within the chip. For example, an SRAM may be located in the middle of the chip (see FIG. **6A**). A GPU, on the other hand, may be located in the top left corner of the chip. In these cases, the monitor spot needs to be shifted to the top right portion of the chip. And for other type of chips, the SRAM may not be necessarily located in the middle of the chip and the GPU may not be necessarily located in the top right corner of the chip. This is shown in FIG. **6B**. Accordingly, in one or more embodiments, a movable stage (e.g., a moveable device) can move in various directions to adjust the monitor spot.

(56) SRAM, for example, is a chip that has a high density. The SRAM as well as the above mentioned components are critical components of the chip **600** which require monitoring during the processing of the chip **600** (e.g., laser anneal process). FIG. **6B** is a layout of another example chip **650** having thereon various components. Contrary to the chip **600** in FIG. **6A**, the locations and arrangements of the various components are different from that shown in the chip **650** of FIG. **6B**. For instance, while the GPUs **620** were located mostly around the upper left corner of the chip **600**, the GPUs **660** of the chip **650** are located on the upper right corner or the upper central region. For example, while the CPUs **610** were located above the bottom right corner of the chip **600**, the CPUs **670** of the chip **650** are located on the bottom right corner. Further, the size, the number, and the precise location of the CPUs/GPUs of the second chip **650** is different from the first chip **600**. That is, every chip will mount circuit components at different locations based on various design requirements. Further, some components may not be present. For example, there are no SRAMs shown in the chip **650**.

(57) Accordingly, because the location of the critical components such as CPUs, GPUs, SRAMs, or the like, differs from every chip, the first and second movable devices **510**, **520** can change the location of where the light signals **115** are emitted towards to offset for the different location of the critical components within each chip.

(58) Referring to FIG. **5**, in some embodiments, the position of the heating source **140** is fixed. That is, for example, it is beneficial for the probe laser **110** to move as the laser shot (from the heating source **140**) against the substrate **150** is generally fixed. Thus, the first moveable device

510 can move around, for example, in a direction shown in the arrow to locate the critical components for each chip. Additionally or alternatively, the second moveable device **520** may move around in a direction shown in the arrow to locate the critical components during the laser anneal process. In some embodiments, both the first moveable device **510** and the second moveable device **520** may move together to locate the position of the critical components for each chip. In one or more embodiments, the light emitting source **110** and the detector **120** may be fixated within the first moveable device **510** at a certain location and may move together with the first moveable device **510** to adjust the monitor spot of the substrate **150**. In further embodiments, the second moveable device **520** that adjusts the position of the substrate **150** and the first moveable device **510** that adjusts the position of the light emitting source **110** and the detector **120** can be provided together. In these embodiments, the offset distance (e.g., a distance that needs to be adjusted to monitor the temperature of various critical components such as the CPU, GPU, SRAM, etc., within select locations in a chip) may be reduced or minimized.

(59) FIG. 7 is a graph illustrating the range of energy density capable of being detected using a combination of emission signals and reflectivity signals according to temperature measuring apparatus of the present disclosure. As shown, FIG. 7 describes that by detecting energy density through emission signals at the detector **120**, it is possible to detect the change of the temperature of the surface of the substrate **150** when the energy density of the substrate **150** starting at the B interval (the B interval includes the section where emission signal changes). That is, the detector **120** measuring the energy density of the substrate **150** can detect energy densities within the B interval. In the A interval (the A interval includes the section where there is no change in emission signals), the minimal or no reflectivity changes or emission changes is detected. In the D interval (the D interval includes the section where both the reflectivity signal and the emission signal are saturated), the reflectivity and emission signals are saturated.

(60) The detector **120** can start detecting the energy density of the substrate **150** through the reflectivity signals at the C interval (the C interval includes the section where reflectivity signal changes). Namely, by using the emission signals, the detector **120** can start detecting lower energy densities compared to using reflectivity signals. As explained above, using only the reflectivity signals caused the inaccurate timing of noticing temperature changes of the substrate. The method of using the emission signals also shows a tight threshold value which is also an improvement compared to the method of using the reflectivity signals. The threshold value is important in that it assists in identifying the condition of the various processes (e.g., anneal process, thermal process, or the like). For example, a threshold point for process condition for an anneal process may be identified.

(61) FIGS. 8A and 8B are graphs showing that a light emitting source may be calibrated to improve reflectivity according to the present disclosure.

(62) FIGS. 8A and 8B show the light emitting source **110**, for example the probe laser, being calibrated under various conditions. Here, in FIG. 8A, the x-axis is reflectivity (%) and the y-axis is the reflectivity signal which varies from -1.0V to 0.872V. As indicated by the graph, the reflectivity at melting temperature for Si (e.g., a bare Si wafer) is about 78%. However, the reflectivity for Si at room temperature is 47%. Accordingly, under specific conditions including ambient temperatures, the quality of the light emitting source **110** may be improved.

(63) In FIG. 8B, the x-axis is reflectivity (%) and the y-axis is the reflectivity initial amplitude (mV). By calibrating the light emitting source **110**, it is possible to define the dark level (e.g., offset) and the reflectivity of various materials of the substrate. In this case, FIG. 8B shows the reflectivity changes of a bare Si. Based on the variations of the reflectivity of the Si, it is possible to determine the conditions including the threshold points for the thermal process (e.g., thermal anneal process).

(64) FIG. 9 is a method **900** of evaluating a temperature of a substrate according to some embodiments of the present disclosure. The method includes producing light signals, using a light

emitting source (at step S910). The light signals have transverse magnetic waves and transverse electric waves. The method further includes polarizing the light signals having the transverse magnetic waves and the transverse electric waves (at step S920). The method further includes propagating polarized light signals including the transverse electric waves from the light emitting source toward the substrate (at step S930). The method further includes reflecting the polarized light signals at the substrate (at step S940). The method further includes receiving the reflected polarized light signals at a detector (at step S950). The method further includes receiving, at the detector, emission signals associated with at least one of a temperature or energy density of a surface of the substrate (at step S960). The method further includes evaluating a temperature of the surface of the substrate using the reflected polarized light signals and the emission signals (at step S970).

(65) In one or more embodiments, an in situ method to monitor laser anneal process temperature is described. The in situ method to monitor laser anneal process involves using a polarized probe laser and an emission detector. The emission detector is configured to detect the reflectivity signals and the emission signals. The two signals received at the emission detector may be used to compute temperature of various structures on the substrate.

(66) Further aspects of the present disclosure are provided to improve sensitive in situ monitoring of the various thermal processes.

(67) One embodiment of the present disclosure provides a temperature evaluating system for a substrate. The system includes a light emitting source, which, in operation, produces light signals. The system further includes a polarizer, which, in operation, receives transverse magnetic waves and transverse electric waves from the light emitting source and transmits polarized light signals toward the substrate at a selected incident angle. Here, the polarized light signals include the transverse electric waves of the light signals. The system further includes a detector, which, in operation receives reflectivity signals that includes the transverse electric waves of the light signals reflected from a surface of the substrate. The detector, in operation, further receives emission signals emitted from the surface of the substrate. The emission signals vary with at least one of a temperature or energy density of the surface of the substrate.

(68) Yet another embodiment of the present disclosure provides a temperature measuring apparatus for a substrate. The apparatus includes a light emitting source, which, in operation, produces light signals. The apparatus further includes a polarizer configured to receive the light signals including the transverse magnetic waves and the transverse electric waves from the light emitting source, and polarize the received light signals and transmit polarized light signals toward a substrate. The polarized light signals include the transverse electric waves of the light signals. The apparatus further includes a detector, which, in operation receives reflectivity signals that include the transverse electric waves of the light signals reflected from a surface of the substrate. The detector, in operation, further receives emission signals emitted from the surface of the substrate. The emission signals are representative of at least one of a temperature or energy density of the surface of the substrate. The apparatus further includes one or both of a first movable stage and a second movable stage. The first movable stage has mounted thereon the light emitting source and the detector. The first movable stage is configured to move the light emitting source and the detector. The second movable stage supports the substrate. The second movable stage is configured to move the substrate.

(69) The foregoing outlines features of several embodiments so that those skilled in the art may better understand the aspects of the present disclosure. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that they may readily use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying other processes and structures for carrying out the same purposes and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein. Those skilled in the art should also realize that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and that

they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A temperature evaluating system for a substrate, comprising: a light emitting source, which, in operation, produces light signals, the light signals having transverse magnetic waves and transverse electric waves; a polarizer, which, in operation, receives transverse magnetic waves and transverse electric waves from the light emitting source and transmits polarized light signals toward a surface of the substrate at a selected incident angle, wherein the polarized light signals include the transverse electric waves of the light signals, the selected incident angle with respect to the surface of the substrate being between about 10° to 80°; a detector, which, in operation: receives reflectivity signals that includes the transverse electric waves of the light signals reflected from the surface of the substrate; and receives emission signals emitted from the surface of the substrate, wherein the emission signals vary with at least one of a temperature or energy density of the surface of the substrate.
2. The temperature evaluating system of claim 1, further comprising a laser to heat the surface of the substrate, the laser positioned above the substrate, wherein the laser operates at a range of wavelengths between about 300 nm to 320 nm.
3. The temperature evaluating system of claim 1, wherein the light emitting source includes a probe laser.
4. The temperature evaluating system of claim 1, further comprising a processor, which, in operation, determines the temperature of the surface of the substrate based on the following equation: $T = \frac{A}{\ln(1 + B \cdot T_{RE})}$ wherein T is the temperature of the substrate, A and B are a constant parameter, ϵ is emissivity which equals 1-R %, R is the reflectivity signals, and TRE is the emission signals.
5. The temperature evaluating system of claim 4, wherein the detector is configured to receive a range of wavelengths of the emission signals that is between about 1500 nm (nanometer) to 1600 nm, and receive a range of wavelengths of the reflectivity signals that is between about 620 nm to 650 nm.
6. The temperature evaluating system of claim 1, further comprising: a first movable stage to which the light emitting source and the detector are mounted, the first movable stage being configured to move the light emitting source and the detector with at least two degrees of freedom.
7. The temperature evaluating system of claim 1, further comprising: a second movable stage for supporting the substrate, the second movable stage configured to move the substrate with at least two degrees of freedom.
8. A temperature measuring apparatus for a substrate, comprising: a light emitting source, which, in operation, produces light signals, the light signals having transverse magnetic waves and transverse electric waves; a polarizer configured to receive the light signals including the transverse magnetic waves and the transverse electric waves from the light emitting source, polarize the received light signals and transmit polarized light signals toward a substrate, wherein the polarized light signals include the transverse electric waves of the light signals; a detector, which, in operation: receives reflectivity signals that includes the transverse electric waves of the light signals reflected from a surface of the substrate, and receives emission signals emitted from the surface of the substrate, wherein the emission signals are representative of at least one of a temperature or energy density of the surface of the substrate; a first movable stage having thereon mounted the light emitting source and the detector, the first movable stage configured to move the light emitting source and the detector; and a processor configured to process the emission signals and the reflectivity signals, wherein the processor evaluates the temperature of the surface of the substrate based on the

following equation: $T = \frac{A}{\ln(1 + B \cdot \frac{TRE}{\epsilon})}$ wherein T is the temperature of the substrate, A and B are a constant parameter, ϵ is emissivity which equals 1-R %, R is the reflectivity signals, and TRE is the emission signals.

9. The temperature measuring apparatus of claim 8, wherein the processor is further configured to evaluate the temperature of the surface of the substrate.

10. The temperature measuring apparatus of claim 8, wherein the first movable stage is configured to move the light emitting source and the detector with either two degrees of freedom or three degrees of freedom.

11. The temperature measuring apparatus of claim 8, further comprising a second movable stage for supporting the substrate, the second movable stage configured to move the substrate and wherein the second movable stage is configured to move the substrate in a first direction and in a second direction that is transverse to the first direction.

12. A temperature evaluating system, comprising: a light emitting source configured to produce light signals, the light signals having transverse magnetic waves (TM) and transverse electric waves (TE); a polarizer configured to polarize the light signals having the transverse waves and transverse electric waves; a detector configured to: receive the polarized light signals reflected from a substrate, the reflected polarized light signals being reflected at a surface of the substrate; receive emission signals associated with at least one of a temperature or energy density of the surface of the substrate; and one or more processors operatively coupled to the detector, the one or more processors configured to evaluate the temperature of the surface of the substrate using the reflected polarized light signals and the emission signals, wherein the light emitting source is positioned such that the light signals after being polarized by the polarizer is at an incident angle between about 10° to 80° with respect to the surface of the substrate.

13. The temperature evaluating system of claim 12, wherein the one or more processors are configured to calculate the temperature of the surface of the substrate based on the following equation: $T = \frac{A}{\ln(1 + B \cdot \frac{TRE}{I})}$ wherein T is the temperature of the substrate, A and B are a constant parameter, ϵ is emissivity which equals 1-R %, R is an intensity of the reflected polarized light signals, and TRE is an intensity of the emission signals.

14. The temperature evaluating system of claim 12, wherein receiving emission signals associated with at least one of a temperature or energy density of the surface of the substrate includes, receiving a range of wavelengths of the emission signals that is broader than a range of wavelengths of the reflected polarized light signals.

15. The temperature evaluating system of claim 14, wherein the range of wavelengths of the emission signals is between about 1500 nm to 1600 nm and the range of wavelengths of the reflected polarized light signals is between about 620 nm to 650 nm.

16. The temperature evaluating system of claim 12, further comprising: a first movable stage configured to move the light emitting source and the detector with respect to the substrate, wherein the light emitting source and the detector are connected to the first movable stage and the first movable stage has at least two degrees of freedom of movement.

17. The temperature evaluating system of claim 12, further comprising: a second movable stage configured to support the substrate thereon, the second movable stage further configured to move the substrate with respect to the light emitting source and the detector, wherein the second movable stage has at least two degrees of freedom of movement.

18. The temperature evaluating system of claim 6, further comprising: a second movable stage for supporting the substrate, the second movable stage configured to move the substrate with at least two degrees of freedom.

19. The temperature measuring apparatus of claim 8, wherein the detector is configured to receive a range of wavelengths of the emission signals that is between about 1500 nm (nanometer) to 1600 nm, and receive a range of wavelengths of the reflectivity signals that is between about 620 nm to

650 nm.

20. The temperature measuring apparatus of claim 8, wherein the light emitting source is positioned such that the light signals after being polarized by the polarizer is at an incident angle between about 10° to 80° with respect to the surface of the substrate.
